



Name: Cohort/Batch: Date: Score:

PUB/SUB PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Cloud

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Pub/Sub and what is its primary purpose in its ecosystem? **cloud**

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Q6 How do you manage configuration and secrets for Pub/Sub? **Pub/Sub**

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Q2 How does IAM work with Pub/Sub? **Architecture**

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Q7 What are the main cost drivers for Pub/Sub and how do you optimize them? **you**

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Q3 How do you monitor Pub/Sub in production? **Configuration**

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Q8 How do you implement high availability with Pub/Sub? **Compliance**

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Q4 How do you scale Pub/Sub to handle variable load? **Hardening**

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Q9 How does Pub/Sub integrate with a CI/CD pipeline? **Testing**

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Q5 How do you secure Pub/Sub in production? **SSO / IdP**

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Q10 What are common pitfalls when first adopting Pub/Sub? **Tuning**

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ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Pub/Sub is a managed cloud service that

Mitigation

Pub/Sub is a managed cloud service that handles a specific infrastructure concern (compute, storage, messaging, AI). Using it shifts operational burden to the cloud provider while you focus on application logic.

A6 Store sensitive values in a managed secret

Observability

Store sensitive values in a managed secret store (AWS Secrets Manager, GCP Secret Manager, Azure Key Vault). Inject secrets as environment variables at runtime, never bake them into container images or source code.

A2 Access to Pub/Sub is controlled via IAM

Primitives

Access to Pub/Sub is controlled via IAM roles and policies. Attach the minimum required permissions to a service account or role. Avoid long-lived access keys; use instance roles or Workload Identity Federation instead.

A7 Cost in Pub/Sub typically comes from compute

Automation

Cost in Pub/Sub typically comes from compute hours, data transfer, storage, and request counts. Right-size instances, use reserved capacity for steady-state workloads, and enable lifecycle policies to expire old data.

A3 Pub/Sub emits metrics to the cloud provider's

Hardening

Pub/Sub emits metrics to the cloud provider's monitoring service (CloudWatch, Cloud Monitoring, Azure Monitor). Set alerts on key metrics (error rate, latency, capacity). Use distributed tracing to correlate across services.

A8 Deploy Pub/Sub across multiple availability zones. Use

Governance

Deploy Pub/Sub across multiple availability zones. Use managed replicas or active-active configurations. Implement health checks and automatic failover. Test resilience regularly with chaos engineering or failover drills.

A4 Pub/Sub supports auto-scaling policies based on CPU, queue depth, or custom metrics. Set minimum and maximum capacity. Horizontal scaling (more instances) is generally preferred over vertical for cloud workloads.

Gotchas

A9 CI/CD pipelines use the cloud CLI or SDK to deploy updates to Pub/Sub after tests pass. Infrastructure-as-code (Terraform, CDK) defines Pub/Sub configuration as version-controlled code deployed via the pipeline.

Assessment

A5 Place Pub/Sub in a private subnet with

Federation

Place Pub/Sub in a private subnet with no public endpoint where possible. Use VPC security groups or firewall rules to allow only required traffic. Encrypt data at rest and in transit. Rotate credentials regularly.

A10 Common mistakes include misconfigured IAM policies (too permissive), no cost alerting, deploying only in one availability zone, and missing backups. Read the service SLA carefully to understand what the cloud provider guarantees.

Configuration